DINESH R. PODDATURI, Ph.D.

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Applied economist working at the intersection of industrial organization, pricing, and experimentation, with over two years as an economist and pricing advisor across 20+ client engagements and $27M in cumulative incremental revenue through demand estimation, controlled experimentation, and pricing optimization. Combines structural and reduced-form econometric methods, including demand estimation and merger simulation, with hands-on client advisory experience translating economic analysis into decisions organizations act on.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Economist
Jul 2023 – Nov 2025; Oct 2026 – Present

Digonex (Dynamic Pricing Company) · Indianapolis, IN

- Generated $27M in cumulative incremental revenue (+34.6% over the engagement period) across 20+ client engagements in the U.S., U.K., and Canada through demand elasticity estimation, discrete choice analysis, and pricing optimization.
- Delivered $4.2M in pricing impact for a single client over three months by implementing dynamic pricing against real-time demand signals. Identified willingness-to-pay above the client's internal price ceiling, built the counterfactual case for lifting it, and earned expanded advisory scope as a result.
- Grew a client's annual revenue from $15.5M to $23M in 2025 by calibrating pricing dynamically to product value enhancements introduced during the year, adjusting recommendations as new demand data accumulated over the year.
- Built a centralized analytics pipeline integrating 100+ datasets across the entire client base, substantially reducing turnaround time on reporting and counterfactual analysis. Designed and executed A/B testing protocols to validate pricing recommendations causally before full deployment.
- Designed a segmented pricing experiment that produced an unexpected cross-segment revenue lift. Discounts targeted at one customer group drove higher purchase volume from a second group, producing net revenue growth that exceeded single-segment projections.

Doctoral Researcher
Aug 2018 – May 2023

Department of Economics, Iowa State University · Ames, IA

Dissertation: "A Dynamic Model of U.S. Beef Cattle." Dynamic structural estimation and counterfactual policy analysis.

- Developed dynamic structural economic models of the U.S. beef cattle industry integrating agent optimization, biological constraints, age and gender distribution, and market clearing conditions across 14 datasets.
- Designed a semi-genetic optimization algorithm combining biological population dynamics with market equilibrium conditions to calibrate the structural model.
- Produced 10-year demand and pricing forecasts outperforming USDA benchmark projections by 5%, enabling scenario-based policy analysis for disease outbreak response and national traceability program design.
- Estimated short-run and long-run producer surplus impacts of a mandatory national animal identification and traceability system under varying cost-sharing programs and adoption rates, providing quantitative guidance for agricultural policymakers.
- Led three end-to-end research projects from structural estimation and counterfactual simulation design through presentation at three national economics conferences (WAEA 2022, AAEA 2021, AAEA 2020).

Software Developer & Data Analyst
May 2014 – Jul 2018

Iowa State University Extension and Outreach / Department of Agronomy · Ames, IA

- Developed two web-based market analysis tools in Java and SQL for beef and pork producers, used across the U.S. and nine international countries. Improved product performance by 15% through systematic code review and debugging.
- Analyzed 15,000 records of print jobs, supply invoices, and labor hours from the department's poster and paper printing service, validating labor and equipment costs to determine whether the service was breaking even, and recommended price increases based on the results.

- Recommended statistical methods and designed experiments for researchers across multiple departments, contributing to three industry-facing publications.

Systems Engineer, Business Platforms
Mar 2012 – Dec 2013

Infosys Limited · Hyderabad, India

- Led a team of six engineers on an online banking software product as project lead, assigning responsibilities, developing modules alongside the team, reviewing completed work through systematic test cases, and coaching team members through improvements.
- Automated enterprise application deployment into production, increasing team productivity by 10%, and presented business analysis findings to senior management to secure project funding.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics 2018 – 2023
Iowa State University, Ames, IA | Dissertation: Dynamic structural modeling, demand estimation, counterfactual simulation, agricultural policy analysis

M.S., Statistics 2016 – 2018
Iowa State University, Ames, IA

M.S., Information Systems 2014 – 2016
Iowa State University, Ames, IA

B.Tech., Electronics and Communication Engineering 2007 – 2011
CVR College of Engineering, India

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Working Papers

Poddaturi, D.R. (2026). Profit-Aware Pricing in Two-Sided Marketplaces: Demand Elasticity, Cost Uncertainty, and Customer Lifetime Value in Brazilian E-Commerce. Working paper. Available at SSRN.

Poddaturi, D.R. (2026). Estimating the Price Effects of the Blocked JetBlue-Spirit Merger: A BLP Demand Estimation and Merger Simulation. Working paper. Available at dineshpoddaturi.github.io.

Open Source

- Poddaturi, D.R. (2026). Switchback Experiment Framework for Marketplaces. Python implementation of switchback design for a delivery-fee change in a three-sided marketplace, with treatment assignment, outcome simulation, and power analysis. Available on GitHub.

Selected Conference Presentations

- "A Dynamic Assessment of the Economic Impacts of a Foot-and-Mouth Disease Outbreak on the U.S. Beef Cattle Industry." Western Agricultural Economics Association, Santa Fe, NM. June 2022.
- "Implementing a National Animal Identification and Traceability Program." Agricultural & Applied Economics Association, Austin, TX. August 2021.
- "A Dynamic Model of U.S. Beef Cattle." Agricultural & Applied Economics Association, Virtual. August 2020.

Industry Publications

- Poddaturi, D.R., Dahlke, G., Euken, R., Schulz, L. (2018). Development of a CRUSH Margin Calculator for Beef and Pork Markets. Iowa State University Animal Industry Report. ASL R3221.
- Poddaturi, D.R., Dahlke, G., Johnson, S. (2016). Management Minder — A Web Based Data Management Application. Iowa State University Animal Industry Report. ASL R3052.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometrics & Methods Industrial organization, causal inference, demand estimation, discrete choice models, BLP random-coefficients models, counterfactual analysis, merger simulation, merger and antitrust analysis, experimental design, switchback experiments, difference-in-differences, synthetic controls, two-sided market analysis, structural and reduced-form econometric modeling, CLV modeling, panel data methods

Pricing & Strategy Profit optimization, dynamic pricing, customer segmentation, sensitivity analysis, scenario analysis, executive communication of pricing trade-offs

Programming & Tools Python, R, Stata, SQL, Java, LaTeX, Git, RStudio, Visual Studio

References available upon request